

Everyone Else • 38/39 • Narjis Khatun

The House That Kept a Secret. Narjis kept a birth secret for months, in a house being watched, and told almost no one until it was already over. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

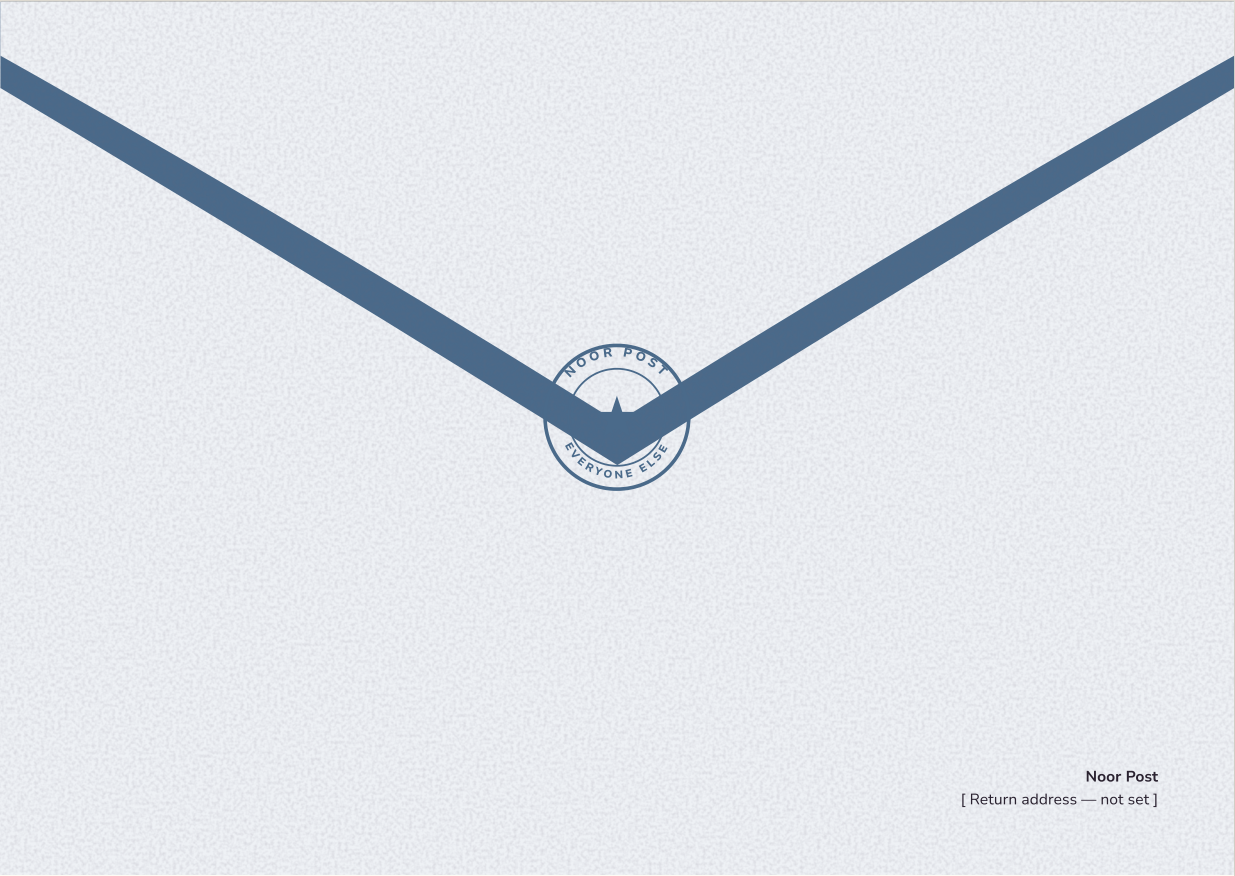
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

Narjis kept a birth secret for months, in a house being watched, and told almost no one until it was already over.

FOR

[Child's name]





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE · NARJIS
KHATUN · INSIDE THE
FLAP

Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

FACT PANEL

Narjis Khatun

- **Who she was.** Wife of Imam al-Askari, and mother of Imam al-Mahdi.
- **What she is remembered for.** Carrying her pregnancy with great secrecy, in a household under close watch by a government wary of exactly this birth.
- **What that required.** Sustained discretion over months, within a small circle of trust, in a house that could not risk drawing outside attention to itself.
- **What this letter does not do.** Explain the occultation itself, or what it means — that belongs to envelope-10.md, held to the same restraint.
- **Why she is in this envelope.** *Narjis kept a birth secret for months, in a house being watched, and told almost no one until it was already over.*

Accounts of her later life vary and are held here loosely, per the same practice as the fact panel for Hakima Khatun in envelope 10.

EVERYONE ELSE • NARJIS KHATUN

The House That Kept a Secret

• is the grown-up • ◦ is you • ●◦ is together

- Narjis lived in the most watched house in Samarra. Samarra was a garrison city — the caliph had built it for his army, and her family had been moved there so the army could keep an eye on them. The government kept men on that street whose only job was to notice who went in and who came out.

◦ **Watching for what?**

- A baby. That was the whole job. They had been told a child would be born in that house, and they meant to know the same hour it happened.

◦ **Why would they care about a baby?**

- Because of whose son he would be. That family had been watched by one caliph after another for two hundred years by then — grandfather, father, son, each one in turn. A government frightened of a family does not wait for the child to grow up. It waits by the door.

◦ **Did she know they were out there?**

THE HOUSE THAT KEPT A SECRET · CONTINUED

- Every day of it. And she did the hard thing anyway. She carried a whole pregnancy through that street without the street ever learning there was one.

- **How do you hide a baby?**

- You keep the house exactly as it has always been. The same visitors, the same hours, the washing out on the same days. Nothing new for anyone to notice. A few people were told, once, and never again after that.

- **How long did that last?**

- Months. Every one of them.

- **Could you keep a secret for months? Say honestly.**

- Most people could not manage a week. She did it with soldiers on the corner and her husband's name on a list, and when the baby came the street learned nothing then either.

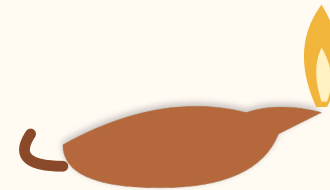
- **So what do we know about her?**

- Almost nothing, and that is the strange part. A house that gives nothing away leaves nothing behind. Most of what anyone would want to know about those years is missing — and the missing is how we know it worked.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**The whole road was
watching. Nobody saw a
thing.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION · 38/39

NO SAYING SELECTED

Blocked on a source — nothing prints here until
its row on citation-sheet.md reads V

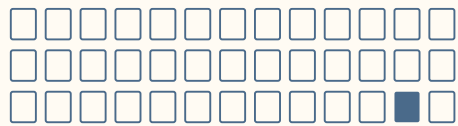


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT · THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

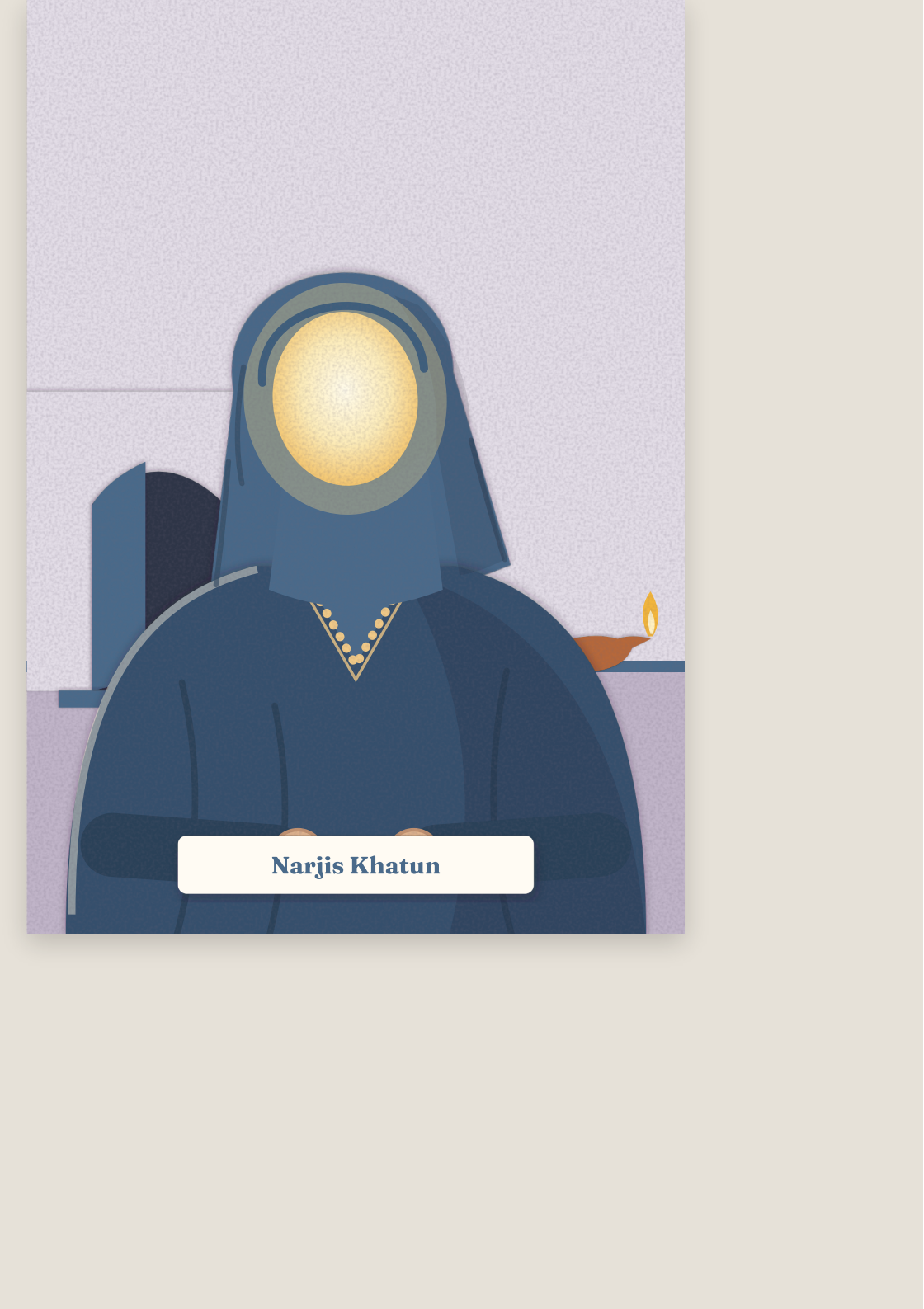
The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

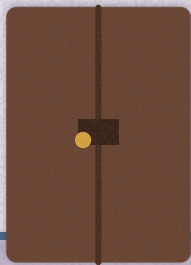
Blocked: Same as 35 — Kitab al-Ghayba held, no conduct-register
tawqi' found.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number



Narjis Khatun





**We opened this one
together.**

• _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.



Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
